

MOSCOVITAS



YIELD 30-35 cookies	OVEN 180C / 356F, about 10 min	UNIT WEIGHT 40 g	ENERGY COST \$1.38 (10 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)
PRICE \$3			

DETAILS

- Tags: vegetarian

INGREDIENTS

100 g	Almonds, toasted
100 g	Heavy cream, 38% fat
100 g	Powdered sugar
20 g	All-purpose flour
150 g	Chocolate, for coating

METHOD

- Crush the almonds but stop short of powder. Some texture is the point.
- Warm the cream with the powdered sugar over medium heat until completely smooth.
- Stir in the crushed almonds and sifted flour, then take it off the heat.
- The mix should be loose but with body. Spoon roughly a teaspoon per cookie onto parchment.
- Space them well apart. They spread a lot.
- Bake at 180C for about 10 minutes, top and bottom heat.
- Cool completely on the tray before touching them.
- Melt the chocolate gently, then coat the flat underside of each cooled cookie.
- Let the chocolate set before serving.

NOTES

Only 20 g of flour against 100 g each of almonds, cream and sugar, which is why these come out as a thin lace cookie rather than anything cakey.
 Cream needs 35% fat minimum. 38% is better.
 Toasting the almonds is what makes them crunchy. Two or three minutes longer in the oven gets them crisper still.
 Walnuts or hazelnuts work instead of almonds.
 The chocolate goes on the base only, not the top.
 The bakery-site entry for this had a completely different formula, with hazelnut, cocoa, butter and eggs. That was not this recipe. These quantities are the real one.

PRESERVING

Keeps well airtight in a dry place. Humidity is the enemy, since it softens the lace and dulls the snap.
 Let the chocolate set fully before stacking, or the coating marks.
 Do not refrigerate. Condensation ruins the texture.

LEARNINGS

- Top of the whole collection at 5 overall, straight 5s on appearance, texture and flavor, ahead of Milk Powder butter cookies at 4.75. The catch is the technique, which is tedious: spooning 30 to 35 individual portions, then hand-coating every base with chocolate once cooled. Worth it, but not a weeknight bake.